

A pathname can refer to any element in the tree. An absolute pathname begins with the character `/`. It indicates the root directory, which contains all other directories and files. It then lists each child directory that must be navigated to reach particular elements, each separated by a `/` sign.

A relative pathname does not begin with `/`. In this instance, the directory tree is explored from a specified point, termed the current directory, depending on context. There are two special directories in every directory named. It corresponds to the directory itself and its parent directory, respectively.



The `/` or root directory

## **`/` – The Directory of the Root**

The `/` directory is often called the root directory. It contains everything about your Linux operating system. The `/` directory is comparable to `C:` directory on Windows. However, this still is not entirely accurate because Linux does not name the hard drive with letters. On Windows, you can find another partition in the `D:` directory. On Linux, you will find this in a different location under `/`.

## **`/bin` – Essential User Binaries**

When our system is configured as a single-user system, the `/bin` directory (or folder) includes the necessary user binaries (programs). It houses critical system applications and utility applications like the Bash shell. On the other hand, `/usr/bin` (i.e. the `/bin` folder under `/usr`) houses applications like Firefox.

Because the `/usr` directory could be found on different disks, putting select files in the `/bin` directory declares that our system could have these essential tools even when no other system files are mounted. Similarly, `/sbin` directory includes crucial system administrative binaries.